

Vladimir Golubev

BACKEND TECH LEAD & SOFTWARE ARCHITECT

Backend engineer → tech lead. I'm the one fuzzy specs go to die.

13+ yrs high-load / high-throughput systems | 7,000 req/sec | stats core live 10+ yrs | System Design | Distributed Systems | Microservices | ClickHouse | AWS | AI-augmented development

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Summary

Backend engineer turned technical lead — 13+ years building, scaling and owning production systems, with team-leadership and lead/architect responsibilities since 2018. I design high-load distributed backends and I'm accountable for the architectural decisions behind them.

Plain version of what I do: requirements analysis and system design (I'd rather pick a fuzzy spec apart for an hour than ship a bug for a month), architecture trade-off decisions (monolith vs. microservices, relational SQL vs. column-store — I choose by load, not by trend), and the documentation, code review and testing discipline that keep systems alive for years.

PROOF POINTS

- Designed and scaled a multi-tenant **CPA (cost-per-action / affiliate marketing) platform** whose API peaked at **7,000 requests per second**.
- A real-time **statistics / analytics core** I architected in 2016 is still running in production a decade later.
- Integrated **four payment gateways end-to-end** (payment processing / billing integration).
- Early adopter of **ClickHouse** for analytics; drove team-wide adoption of Vue.js and Docker.
- Led a backend team from 2018 — code review, mentoring, architectural sign-off, automated-testing rollout.

AI-augmented development as a default, not a novelty. I use Claude / Claude Code, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Codex daily, and I own the agentic harness end-to-end. I stress-test AI-assisted workflows in my independent game and web studio (nomorecare.gg), where I am sole architect, engineer and operator.

Core stack: PHP (5–8), Laravel, system design, microservices, distributed systems, AWS, ClickHouse, Terraform, Docker, Redis; relational and NoSQL databases (MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, MongoDB, Couchbase, DynamoDB, OpenSearch).

Open to Tech Lead, Software Architect and Staff Engineer roles where trade-offs and decisions matter more than volume of code. Remote-first, based in Novi Sad, Serbia, on Belgrade time (CET/CEST, UTC+1/+2). Available B2B via a Georgian individual entrepreneur; also open to employment under Serbian labour law. English C1, Russian native.

Work Experience

AI Architect — NoMoreCare · Jun 2026 – Present · Self-employed / Remote Independent game and web development studio. Own product design, software architecture, AI-assisted development and operations. • Developed and launched Bunchill (bunchill.co), a web app for choosing entertainment together, with shared lists and voting; owned the Rust / SQLite backend, frontend and deployment. • Developed and launched attic.wladyspb.pro, owning the website's implementation and publishing workflow. • Developing BuildYourSkillTree in Godot / C#: branching skill trees, resource progression and ascension mechanics, with automated tests and UI verification. Rust, Python, C#, Godot, AI Pipelines, OpenHands SDK, Codex, SQLite, Jev, LM Studio
Senior Backend Engineer / Tech Lead — Quintegro · Jul 2022 – Jun 2026 · Remote Technical lead and senior backend engineer across confidential automotive analytics and marketplace products. • As tech lead and senior backend engineer, designed from scratch the backend for a rare-vehicle market analytics service: processed 300,000+ historical sale records, produced aggregates across multiple market dimensions, and delivered date-aware currency conversion, watched-data alerts and request-history recommendations. • On a confidential RV marketplace with 20,000 active listings, moved image processing out of the request path into background jobs, delivering a several-fold speed-up for multi-image upload workflows. • Built a local development framework for a 43-microservice fleet, saving roughly 15–20 minutes on every validation iteration and removing contention around one shared dev environment used by four developers and two QA engineers. • Implemented automated abuse controls that fully stopped a coordinated spam-registration campaign; also rewrote an in-house DynamoDB library from raw arrays into a query-builder API. • Owned production releases and incident recovery across both products. Technical Leadership, System Design, Microservices, Distributed Systems, PHP, Laravel, MariaDB, AWS, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, CloudWatch, Terraform, Release Management, Incident Recovery
Senior Backend Developer — Playkot · Jul 2021 – Jun 2022 · St. Petersburg Backend engineer on a live mobile-game backend under production traffic: implemented multi-provider authentication with account linking, and optimised partial-load / lazy-loading patterns over MongoDB for hot player data (performance optimisation under load). PHP, MongoDB, NoSQL, Authentication, Game Backend, Performance Optimization

Senior Backend Developer — Rabota.ru · Oct 2020 – Jun 2021 · St. Petersburg
Backend engineer on one of Russia's largest job boards (high-traffic web platform): built the **in-account customer notification service**, migrated client-account features off a legacy codebase onto the new internal framework (**legacy modernisation**), and extended automated-test coverage across PostgreSQL-backed services.

PHP, PostgreSQL, Notifications, Legacy Migration / Modernization, Test Automation

Lead Backend (PHP) Developer — Smart Line · Apr 2015 – Oct 2020 · St. Petersburg
Grew a small internal PHP utility into offergate.pro — a multi-tenant **CPA (cost-per-action / affiliate marketing) platform** with two product surfaces and a ClickHouse analytics stack.

- Designed a real-time **statistics / analytics core** in 2016 that still runs in production today; the platform API peaked at **7,000 requests per second** (high-load system design).
- Led a small backend team from 2018: code review, mentoring, architectural sign-off, and a team-wide rollout of automated testing.
- Early ClickHouse adopter for analytics; initiated the team's migration to Vue.js and containerisation with Docker.
- Integrated **four payment gateways end-to-end** — WebMoney, Platron, ePayments, bank131 (payment processing / billing integration).

Technical Leadership, Team Leadership, Mentoring, System Design, High-Load Systems, PHP 7, Laravel, Vue.js, ClickHouse, MariaDB, Redis, Couchbase, Docker, Payment Gateway Integration

Full-Stack Engineer — TAXOFT · Jan 2013 – Mar 2015 · St. Petersburg
Designed, built and maintained the full software stack of a taxi-aggregator / ride-hailing service end-to-end — first hands-on exposure to production scale and on-call operations.

PHP, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, MySQL, Full-Stack Development

Projects

Bunchill — Creator / Full-Cycle AI Engineer

bunchill.co →

Take an idea from zero to a deployed web service using agent-assisted development. Owned the complete delivery cycle: product definition, frontend, backend, deployment and infrastructure.

NoMoreCare — Independent Game & Web Studio

nomorecare.gg →

Solo (one-person) indie game studio with three roguelike games in development — sole owner of design, software architecture, code, infrastructure and release. Used as a **real-world test bed for agentic AI / LLM-assisted (“AI-in-the-loop”) development workflows**.

AI pet projects include a pipeline for designing web novels and a game-master pipeline for running structured tabletop scenarios; the first game-master version is built on an agent framework and is evaluated as an engineering workflow, not a toy prompt.

NEAR RELEASE: **Terminal Stake** Stock-market roguelike with procedurally generated companies and hidden difficulty scaling. Pure terminal UI.

IN DEV: **Incrememory** Fast auto-battler roguelike with deep upgrade mechanics.

IN DEV: **Increvolution** Ecosystem-management roguelike with evolutionary mechanics.

Skills

PINNED

System Design

Software Architecture

Technical Leadership

roles / seniority

Technical Lead, Software Architect, Staff Engineer, Senior Backend Engineer, Engineering Team Lead

leadership

Technical leadership, Team leadership, Mentoring, Code review, Architectural sign-off / decision ownership, Release management

architecture & systems

System design, Software architecture, Distributed systems, Microservices, Monolithic architecture, High-load / high-throughput systems, Scalability, Performance optimization, API design, REST APIs

languages & runtime

PHP (5, 7, 8), Laravel, JavaScript, SQL, Rust, Python, C#, Godot

data

ClickHouse, MySQL, MariaDB, PostgreSQL, SQLite, MongoDB, Couchbase, DynamoDB, OpenSearch, Redis, NoSQL, Relational databases, Column-store databases, Database design

cloud & infra

AWS, Docker, Terraform, CloudWatch, CI/CD, Linux, Infrastructure as Code

domains

Payment gateway integration, Billing / payment processing, Affiliate / CPA platforms, Marketplaces, Analytics / statistics platforms, Game backends, Notifications

quality

PHPUnit, Behat / BDD (behavior-driven development), Test automation, Technical documentation

ai-augmented development

Claude / Claude Code, ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Codex, Agentic AI, AI Pipelines, Jev, LM Studio, LLM-assisted development, Agentic frameworks, Full-cycle AI product delivery, OpenHands SDK, LLM fine-tuning, Local LLM setup: OpenHands SDK + LM Studio, Python pipelines

frontend (working level)

Vue.js, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

languages

Russian (native), English (C1)